

CAFÉ International

A Support Hub for International Students in Berlin

1. Executive Summary

CAFÉ International is a community-driven initiative that provides international students in Berlin with essential guidance, trusted services, and social integration opportunities. Instead of creating a new café from scratch, the project partners with existing community spaces and initiatives to deliver student support through curated packages. The goal is to reduce the barriers international students face in settling in Berlin, while fostering cross-cultural exchange and local community engagement.

2. Problem Statement

Berlin attracts thousands of international students each year. However, many face the same recurring challenges:

- Navigating bureaucracy (Anmeldung, health insurance, banking).
- Finding safe, affordable accommodation without scams.
- Overcoming social isolation and lack of access to community.
- Limited networks for jobs, volunteering, and integration.

These challenges delay their academic progress, increase stress, and create barriers to long-term success.

3. Our Solution

CAFÉ International offers tiered service packages that provide international students with reliable support, guidance, and opportunities to integrate into Berlin life. By collaborating with existing initiatives, NGOs, and volunteer organizations, we offer students practical help (banking, housing, insurance) and community belonging (events, volunteering, buddy program, language learning).

4. Service Packages

Package	Price	Features
Free Starter Pack	€0	One free coffee, 15-minute consultation with a facilitator, introduction to CAFÉ International packages. Designed to build trust and act as an entry point.
Starter	€50	Anmeldung appointment & guidance, university registration help, welcome coffee, volunteering certificate (after 3 months).

Essentials	€150	Everything in Starter + bank account setup, insurance guidance, safe housing shortlist & tips, public transport guide, access to community events & orientation sessions, one hour monthly coaching (12 months), and a personal facilitator (2 months).
Premium	€250	Everything in Essentials + extended housing support (partner agencies/dorms), skill-building workshops (CV, digital skills), job referral connections, 3-month buddy program with local students, guided roadmap for language learning (peer-supported, 6 months). Includes optional coaching layers for students who seek extended support.

5. Implementation Plan

Phase 1 (August–September 2025):

- Finalize partnerships with community spaces in Neukölln / Kreuzberg / prominent places in Berlin.
- Build and launch website +/- simple app (information hub + package booking).
- Design marketing campaign (targeting incoming winter semester students).
- Pilot Free, Starter & Essentials Packages with 20–30 students.

Phase 2 (October–December 2025):

- Expand services to include Package 3 (Premium).
- Strengthen partnerships with housing agencies, NGOs, and universities.
- Organize monthly community events and volunteering drives.

Phase 3 (2026):

- Scale operations to other Berlin districts.
- Introduce additional services (skill-building, job fairs, cultural exchange programs).

6. Target Group

Primary Target Group – Direct Beneficiaries

International students (non-EU and EU, but especially non-German speakers).

Secondary Target Group – Partners & Collaborators

NGOs, student unions, and community spaces hosting the activities.

Volunteer organizations providing certificates and placements.

Universities and language schools that benefit from better-prepared students.

Local businesses (cafés, co-working spaces, service providers).

Tertiary Target Group – Wider Community & Ecosystem

Local Berlin neighborhoods (e.g., Friedrichshain, Neukölln, Kreuzberg).

Berlin's broader internationalization and reputation as a student-friendly hub.

Policy makers and city programs promoting integration.

7. Impact & Value Creation

- Reduces stress for international students by solving critical settlement issues.
- Strengthens local community ties through volunteering and buddy programs.
- Encourages cultural exchange in Berlin's diverse neighborhoods.
- Builds a sustainable model by partnering with NGOs and community spaces instead of renting expensive new cafés.

8. Financial Model

- Revenue generated through student package sales.
- **Starter**: Low entry fee to build trust and brand visibility.
- **Essentials**: Core revenue driver (~70% expected uptake).
- **Premium**: Higher-margin package with extended services and coaching.
- Partnerships and sponsorships from NGOs, cultural funds, and universities will subsidize events and workshops.

Advisory Note: Marc Leberecht-Schneider has recommended exploring the acquisition of an existing café franchise instead of creating a new location from scratch. This pathway could significantly reduce operational risk, increase sustainability, and make the project more attractive to investors. (03.10.2025)

9. Team

- **Founder/CEO** – international student with firsthand experience of the challenges.
- **Developers (3)** – building websites and apps.
- **German-speaking volunteers** – supporting administration & communication.
- **Advisors/Administrators Board** – ensuring compliance and managing partnerships.

10. Next Steps (Immediate Actions)

- Secure first hosting partnerships with community spaces.
- Build landing website (with package info and booking form).
- Start social media marketing targeting September- November intake students.
- Seek seed funding / small investor support to cover the first 6 months of operations.

11. Partnerships & Support

This initiative is being developed in close exchange with **Generation iTrust** and **Marc Leberecht-Schneider**, whose expertise and network in social innovation and impact-driven entrepreneurship provide valuable guidance during the early stages of the project.

The entire experience of developing, piloting, and scaling CAFÉ International can serve as a **case study for Generation iTrust**, showcasing how international students can be empowered to integrate into Berlin's social and economic fabric through community-based solutions.

Additional Note:

- CAFÉ International is actively seeking support from **other initiatives, facilitators, mentors, guidance advisors, and partners** who are aligned with the project's mission. We are open to **teaming up with like-minded individuals and organizations**.
- This document will continue to be **updated and refined** based on guidance, advice, and suggestions that help achieve the overarching goal of establishing CAFÉ International as a trusted hub for international students.

Advisory Notes from Recent Discussions:

- Launch targeted for **October 2025** via the iTrust website.
- Suggested to include **layered membership and coaching services** within the Premium Package.
- Recommendation to **consider acquiring an existing café franchise** as a more sustainable and fundable alternative to building from scratch.